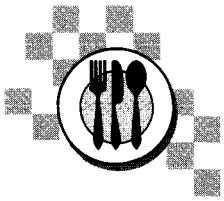
CHAPTER 19



Management and Sanitation

About This Chapter

In this chapter you will learn:

1. Why it is so important for managers to understand good hygiene and support the sanitation program
2. Who managers should involve when developing a sanitation program
3. How managers can help motivate employees and improve the image of sanitation work
4. How sanitation managers can cooperate with the media, outside agencies, and consumers to help the image of the company and promote good relationships
5. What managers need to do to train employees about sanitation
6. Sources of training and education materials
7. How total quality management (TQM) can help the sanitation program

Introduction

Many unskilled workers choose to work in the food-processing and foodservice industries because they do not need any formal training or education. The food industry often employs high school and college students. Many food industry employees are young and have several outside interests, so employee turnover is high.

Most managers in the food industry agree that sanitation employees do not stay on the job long because they have little training and education and therefore have low salaries. It is difficult for managers to hire and train employees to carry out the sanitation program, in other words to do the cleaning. It is also hard for managers to give sanitation work a professional and exciting image so that employees can be proud and enthusiastic about keeping the operation clean and hygienic. Good managers are the key to a good sanitation program.

MANAGEMENT'S ROLE

If management supports the sanitation program, it is likely to work well. If management does not support the sanitation program, it will fail. The rest of this chapter shows how management is important in designing a good sanitation program and making sure employees carry it out.

Managers' Attitude

Many managers in the food industry do not understand how important it is for a food operation to have an organized sanitation program. Unfortunately, if managers do not think sanitation is important, their employees will not take sanitation seriously. Management may not support sanitation programs because they are expensive and do not quickly increase sales and profits. If top management does not understand sanitation, lower and middle management cannot make it a top priority.

Some management teams are enthusiastic about the sanitation program. They know it can help promote the product, increase sales, and make the food product keep longer. Other managers have improved the image of their organization with good sanitation and quality assurance. Many firms realize that a good sanitation program will save money.

Managers' Knowledge of Sanitation

If management does not understand sanitation and does not support the sanitation program, the facility will not have good hygiene. Managers need to support and promote sanitation and provide an example, because it affects how the operation markets their products. Sanitation programs also affect the company's relationship with inspectors. The U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) and local health department can stop the company from preserving, producing, packaging, storing, or selling any food if their facility or process is unsanitary. Managers need to know that a good sanitation program makes cleaning less expensive because it is more efficient.

Developing the Program

Management should design their sanitation program to fit the operation. In a meat-processing operation, many of the conveyors, mixers, and other equipment and containers are open. So the facility needs more hand-held hoses and wands than foam and high-pressure units. A milk plant can use more automatic cleaning equipment such as cleaning-in-place (CIP) systems.

When managers plan the sanitation program, they should get input from the following staff:

1. Employees—especially production supervisors and line workers
2. Quality assurance (QA) personnel—information about areas that need better hygiene and new technology that can improve sanitation

3. Plant engineers—information about equipment maintenance and layouts
4. Purchasing department—how to reduce the cost of equipment and supplies

Managers should give a trained sanitation manager the authority and support he or she needs to make the program work. The sanitation manager should report directly to the plant manager.

The sanitation program should include a Hazard Analysis Critical Control Point (HACCP) program (see Chap. 10). In the future, regulatory agencies may require use of HACCP or a similar program. FDA's Good Manufacturing Practices (GMPs) can help set up a sanitary and hygienic operation because they aim to prevent contamination (adulteration) of foods.

Carrying Out the Program

With good management, everyone involved with sanitation works as a team and shares problems, solutions, and knowledge. For a sanitation program to work, staff need to carry out each step and record the results. Managers can also use an outside sanitation audit to check their sanitation program. Trained auditors have lots of experience and fresh ideas. The sanitation manager or general manager should also carry out an audit regularly. To conform to the HACCP philosophy, sanitation managers should keep a detailed list of problems and what they do to correct them.

Managing a Sanitation Program

Management means "getting things done through people." Sanitation management should get three things done:

1. Delegating sanitation tasks or telling employees what to do
2. Training employees by showing them how to do it
3. Supervising employees to make sure that they do it properly

Managers should inspect the operation regularly to make sure that employees are doing each job properly. Even when managers train employees well, they still need supervision.

Sanitation workers must be able to understand and carry out the sanitation program, and managers must administrate the program properly. Managers cannot afford to make poor decisions about whom to hire or about the sanitation program, because these mistakes could make customers ill. Top management need to understand and support good sanitation and consumer protection.

Management and Supervision

Sanitation programs need good supervision to work properly. Management must audit the sanitation program to make sure that employees are following the rules. Supervisors should always be alert to employees' use of unsafe practices. An ongoing

training program reinforces supervision and keeps sanitary habits in the front of employees' minds.

Supervisors need an organized routine to keep track of a food production facility. Managers should supervise food handlers using the same health standards that are used to screen new employees. Many local health codes state that the operator must tell the health authorities at once if they know or suspect that an employee has or is carrying an infectious disease.

The manager's job is easier if employees are motivated to do a good job. Good training can motivate workers. Employees also have better morale and more motivation when supervisors treat them professionally.

Job Enrichment

Many employees, including managers and supervisors, think of sanitation work as a second-rate job. It is important for managers to make sanitation workers aware of the importance of their job. Good management can make sanitation more glamorous and exciting. An effective job enrichment program can make the work more interesting and rewarding for employees. This program can help workers feel that they have a place in the operation. It can demand more of employees, give them more responsibility, and include self-inspection.

Self-Supervision and Self-Inspection

Supervisors may find it hard to set a good example for other employees, but a supervisor who does not follow the rules will not be able to get employees to follow them either.

Trained managers who are familiar with the operation should inspect the establishment often. The owner/operator, managers, supervisors, or sanitation consultants may carry out these self-inspections. Inspectors can use a checklist to make the inspection more valuable and help compare results between inspections.

Public Relations

Food sanitarians should have good public-relations skills and use them in the sanitation program. They must use every reasonable method to help employees understand the program and motivate them to follow every step.

The mass media can help sanitarians promote hygiene in the community in general. If managers have a relationship with news reporters, they can share information and learn to understand each other. Managers can stress improvements, achievements, new programs, new staff, promotions, and other developments. Newspapers, magazines, and television can help the public, the food industry, and food sanitation personnel understand the program better.

Sanitarians should know how to motivate employees. For example, it is easier to motivate groups than individuals. Food sanitarians can do more than inspect the fa-

cilities. Other productive and rewarding activities include, for example, talking to a school class or civic group, writing news announcements, helping on radio or TV programs, and making educational materials. It is easier to promote and explain food sanitation when community leaders or civic groups understand and support the idea.

Food sanitarians' recommendations often add to the operating costs of the operation. The sanitation manager needs public-relations skills to sell the need and benefits to other managers.

Cooperation with Other Agencies

Joint advisory committees of regulators, industry managers, and sometimes consumers can evaluate new methods and products. These committees may provide counseling on policies and help form and keep good relationships between regulators, industry, and consumers.

HIRING AND TRAINING EMPLOYEES

Hiring Employees

Managers should be careful when selecting employees who will handle food. They must not have or carry an infectious disease and should have excellent personal hygiene. Good candidates will look neat and clean at the interview.

Training Employees

Good training of employees has been stressed many times in this book. Basic sanitation is a vital part of employee training because no food should be prepared in a food establishment unless everything is clean. Sanitation employees should:

- Be serious, dedicated, and professional
- Understand the company's policy on sanitation
- Know their role in sanitation in the organization

Management, employees, regulatory agencies, and consumers all play a role in food sanitation. In a good sanitation program, sanitation staff work closely with quality assurance (QA) and research and development staff to make sure that standards are met. Staff need to develop the idea of working together, rather than have one department checking up on or policing another. Managers should train all staff to work as a team to keep the facility hygienic, rather than being antagonistic.

Management must hire a well-qualified sanitarian. The sanitarian should be educated about the food-processing operation, cleaning and sanitizing compounds, and food microbiology. The sanitarian should also have experience and/or training in cleaning different types of surfaces. He or she needs to know how to choose the right cleaning equipment, cleaning compounds, and sanitizers for the surface depending on its

design, hardness, porosity (whether it soaks things up), vulnerability to oxidation (whether it is damaged by air or oxygen), and susceptibility to corrosion (whether it is eaten away by acid or other chemicals).

A good management team should make sure that the sanitarian knows the following about chemicals used in food sanitation:

- Their safety
- How well they work for specific jobs
- When and how to use detergent auxiliaries and sanitizers
- What type of equipment to use

A sanitarian who understands cleaning equipment, cleaning compounds, and sanitizers can help employees clean efficiently and quickly; waste less time, energy, and cleaning materials; prevent injuries; use less water; and produce less sewage.

When managers give information to sanitation workers, it must be easy to read and understand. Employees should use a clear instruction manual for cleaning all areas and equipment. It should tell employees exactly which cleaning compounds, sanitizers, and equipment to use for each job. The instruction manual should have a sanitation plan and information about pest control, hygienic methods, and maintenance to prevent problems. Use of good hygiene shows in how the facility looks and the quality of the food products, and affects the image of the company.

Customers want and should have wholesome food products. Responsible managers understand that employees need training. These managers have thorough training programs for all employees in their food-processing or foodservice operation. Sanitarians should attend training courses and get help from regulatory agencies to help them train their employees to meet sanitation standards. Management needs to provide training materials, a classroom or area for training, and time for training. The training program is more successful when managers provide good leadership and show enthusiasm for the program.

Other Resources for Sanitation Training and Education

Trade associations and regulatory agencies have information and programs to help managers educate and train employees. Examples are the U.S. Food and Drug Administration, Food Safety and Inspection Service, American Meat Institute, National Food Processors Institute, and National Restaurant Association Educational Foundation. Many of these organizations have instruction manuals for trainers and course books for employees, as well as slides and videos to add interest to the program. Some hold workshops and training sessions around the country. Professional associations such as the International Association of Milk, Food and Environmental Sanitarians help improve the professional status of the sanitarian and educate the food industry about the need for good sanitation programs. Professional associations and universities offer courses on sanitation. A list of names, addresses, and telephone numbers of several of these organizations is shown in Appendix 1.

TOTAL QUALITY MANAGEMENT

Total quality management (TQM) is a management philosophy that allows employees to work with management, have a voice in the operation, and feel some ownership of the firm. TQM is more than a buzz word. This new concept helps management and employees work together for better productivity, lower costs, and more consistent and better products.

TQM and Sanitation

The TQM philosophy applies to management of sanitation. To keep conditions sanitary, each manager and employee needs to take responsibility for keeping the operation hygienic.

In the past, sanitation managers have policed and checked up on employees, instead of having employees be responsible for their own work. TQM involves all employees in decisions and accountability. TQM means offering the customer a consistent and good product through training and hard work by all employees.

In future, food producers are likely to put more emphasis on TQM in their sanitation programs. TQM can help sanitation operations in the same way it has helped manufacturing and service operations. TQM can be a valuable tool for sanitarians.

TQM usually includes a sanitation program for the whole facility, good manufacturing practices (GMPs) for the whole operation, and HACCP program that includes each specific food item.

SUMMARY

- It is very important for managers in the food industry to hire good employees and teach them about good sanitation.
- The sanitation program can only work if management supports it.
- A good sanitation program includes ongoing training and education for employees.
- Education programs can use sanitation training manuals and short courses given by trade associations, professional organizations, or regulatory agencies.
- Sanitation managers decide who will carry out each part of the sanitation program and train and supervise employees.
- Self-supervision and self-inspection are two tools that help keep the operation sanitary.

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STUDY QUESTIONS

1. Which employees and departments should be involved in developing a sanitation program?
2. What are three things sanitarians should do to manage the sanitation program?
3. What are three ways managers can motivate sanitation workers?
4. Why do sanitarians need to know about cleaning equipment and chemicals?
5. Why do sanitarians need good public-relations skills?
6. Define total quality management (TQM).

TO FIND OUT MORE ABOUT MANAGEMENT AND SANITATION

1. Contact the following organizations for information about sanitation management and employee training:

   International Association of Milk, Food, and
   Environmental Sanitarians (IAMFES)
   502 E. Lincoln Way
   Ames, IA 50010-6666
   (515) 232-6699

   National Restaurant Association Educational Foundation
   250 S. Wacker Drive, Suite 1400
   Chicago, IL 60606-5834
   (800) 765-2122

   USDA Meat and Poultry Hotline
   14th Street and Independence Avenue, SW
   Room 1165-South
   Washington, DC 20250
   (800) 535-4555

   United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA)
   5600 Fishers Lane
   Rockville, MD 20857
   (301) 443-1544

2. Contact a foodservice operator or food processor in your area and ask the sanitation manager about his or her job.



SELF-INSPECTION AND SUPERVISION ARE *So* IMPORTANT

Even small catering and foodservice operations need good hygiene and sanitation practices. In small operations, the owner may need to be the sanitation manager. Regulatory agencies cannot inspect food operations very often, especially small operations, so self-inspection is very important.

In May 1989, 140 guests who attended a catered wedding reception in Napa, California, became ill with *Bacillus cereus* gastroenteritis. The investigation showed that the Cornish game hens had carried the infection.

Spores of *B. cereus* bacteria are found almost everywhere, but large numbers of bacteria have to grow and produce toxin to cause illness. Therefore, *B. cereus* is a rare foodborne illness in the United States. In the Napa outbreak, the bacteria had several opportunities to grow and produce toxin while the food was prepared and transported. Some of the unsafe practices were:

1. The Cornish game hens were not completely thawed before cooking, so the cooking time was not long enough to completely cook the meat.
2. The caterer used the same brush to baste the birds before and after they were cooked. This allowed cross-contamination from the raw to the cooked birds.
3. The outdoor temperature on the day of the event was 90°F, and the caterer transported the hens in an unrefrigerated van for 4 1/2 hours while he made a delivery somewhere else in the county.
4. The caterer used a licensed restaurant kitchen, but the facilities were not adequate for the event.

The investigators recommend that government agencies inspect food safety in catering operations more often. In the meantime, small food operations must make sure they know about food safety and must develop and stick to a rigid sanitation program.

Source: Slaten, D. D., Oropeza, R. I., and Werner, S. B. An outbreak of *Bacillus cereus* food poisoning—are caterers supervised sufficiently? *Public Health Reports* 107(4):477-480.